CPT COMBAT & PERFORMANCE TRAINING · MELBOURNE

CANINE PERSONAL TRAINING SYSTEM

10-SESSION DOG TRAINING SYSTEM WITH INDIVIDUAL PRACTICE PERIODS BASED ON THE 5 CPT CLASSICAL PILLARS

01	02	03	04	05
MOVEMENT & S-FLOW	REWARD SOURCE FOCUS	VOCALS & DRIVE SWITCH	DRIVE IGNITION	GRIP & POSITIVE OUT

DEVELOPED BY SOTIR KICHUKOV

ONE Championship Veteran · Bulgarian Striking & MMA Champion · Head Coach at CPT MMA & Canine Personal Training Melbourne. Applying 19 years of championship athletic conditioning and practical canine behavioural science to build motivation, clear communication, and an enjoyable partnership between dog and handler.

CANINE PERSONAL TRAINING PHILOSOPHY

PARTNERSHIP, MOTIVATION & CLEAR COMMUNICATION

Canine Personal Training builds motivation, clear communication and a rewarding partnership between dog and owner. The dog is allowed to look at the food. Eye contact with the handler is not a requirement for earning a reward. We build food drive through enjoyable chasing and luring, then use the lure to guide the dog into positions. Owners learn how their hand movements, footwork and timing influence the dog. As these handling skills improve, guiding the dog forward, backward, through turns and into positions becomes smoother and more enjoyable. That feeling of working together is something every dog owner should experience.

BALL DRIVE & DRIVE SWITCHING (THE "BREAK" MARKER)

We develop ball drive and teach the dog to switch between activities and rewards. For example, during a ball-chasing exercise, the handler can use an established marker such as **"Yes," "Ya" or "Break"**, according to the meaning taught to that dog, to redirect the dog back to them for a single piece of kibble. **The dog learns that returning to the handler and taking that piece of kibble gives access to the bigger reward—in this case, the ball or the opportunity to chase the moving ball.** This understanding is built progressively through clear, consistent practice.

EMERGENCY DOWN & REALISTIC PROGRESSION

You can also teach an **emergency down**, first in a quiet setting, then gradually practise it during more exciting activities as the dog's understanding and reliability improve. Training begins at home, where the owner develops technique and handling skills while the dog learns the exercises. We then introduce manageable distractions, starting somewhere familiar, such as in front of the house. Later, we progress to suitable dog-friendly cafés or hardware shops.

ASSESS HANDLING SKILLS & DOG ABILITIES TOGETHER

At every stage, assess **both your handling skills and your dog's current abilities**. If the dog has not yet learned to walk beside you or remain calm around other dogs, those skills need to be built through consistent training and gradual exposure. Simply taking the dog into a busy environment does not teach it how to behave there.

APPROPRIATE SOCIALISATION & PUPPY FOUNDATIONS

Regular, appropriate socialisation helps build these foundations, ideally beginning during puppyhood. This means learning to feel comfortable and respond to the handler around different people, dogs, sounds and places. It does not require greeting or playing with every dog. Older dogs can also develop these skills through practice suited to their individual needs.

THE 5 CPT CLASSICAL PILLARS

PILLAR	CORE MECHANISM	PET DOG REAL-WORLD APPLICATION
1. Movement & S-Flow	Linear walking causes opposition pulling. S-Flow uses curvilinear loose leash geometry and handler body movement.	Eliminates lead pulling on Melbourne sidewalks. Handler body leads; the dog follows naturally without neck wrestling.
2. Reward Source Focus	Dog is allowed to focus directly on food or reward without compulsory eye contact. Chasing and luring shape behavior.	The dog eagerly tracks the lure and positions. No stress or frustration over forced staring; pure motivation and speed.
3. Vocals & Drive Switching	Clear marker system using *YES*, *YA*, *GOOD*, and *BREAK* to switch and redirect drives cleanly.	Dog learns returning to handler for a piece of kibble unlocks access to higher rewards (the ball or chase).
4. Drive Modulation	Developing food drive, ball drive and handling skills before increasing environmental distractions.	All daily food is earned through focus and fun handling. Destructive household energy is channeled into teamwork.
5. Grip & Play (The Out)	Full-mouth bite mechanics on tugs/balls, followed by the conflict-free positive OUT (second toy or reward swap).	Prevents resource guarding and possession aggression over toys or dropped items. Teaches immediate clean release.

PHASE 1: DRIVE, HANDLING SKILLS & LEASH HEEL

SESSION 1

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Food Drive Ignition & Hand Magnet
Eliminate bowl feeding. Build food drive through enjoyable chasing and luring in a quiet, zero-distraction room.

- **Magnet Hand:** Kibble held between thumb & palm. Dog pushes eagerly into hand while handler moves backward.
- **Opposition Reflex:** Handler pulls away slightly as dog commits to reinforce forward chasing drive.
- **Home Environment:** Conducted entirely inside hallway or quiet room; no external distractions.

Homework: 2x 5-min sessions daily | Goal: High-speed chasing & hand push

SESSION 2

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Reward Focus & Drive Switching (BREAK)
The dog is allowed to look at the food—eye contact is not a requirement. Practice hand and footwork timing.

- **Reward Source Focus:** Lure dog into movement; reward direct focus on the food source without demanding eye contact.
- **Drive Switching (BREAK):** Announce marker (*"Yes," "Ya" or "Break"*) to redirect dog back for kibble, unlocking next movement.
- **Handling Mechanics:** Practice hand placement and footwork rhythm before stepping outside.

Homework: 10 drive-switching reps | Goal: Fluid lure guidance & responsive turn

SESSION 3

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: S-Flow Movement & 3 Kinesthetic Positions
Using hand lures and curved footwork to guide the dog into Sit, Down, and Stand smoothly without verbal friction.

- **Position Shaping:** Upward lure for Sit → nose-to-paws downward for Down → forward draw for Stand.
- **S-Flow Contact Heel:** Lure at hip seam. Walk figure-8s; dog wraps body into handler's leg as handling skills improve.
- **Working Together:** Guiding forward, backward and through turns becomes a rewarding cooperative dance.

Homework: 3x 8-min S-Flow drills | Goal: Clean position transitions on lure

SESSION 4

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Lure Fading, Emergency Down Prep & Loose Leash
Fading the food lure, introducing the *GOOD* duration marker, and building emergency down in quiet settings.

- **Fading the Lure:** Hand mimics lure gesture empty; reward drawn from pouch or pocket post-marker.
- **Emergency Down (Quiet Setting):** Rapid drop into Down from motion in a low-distraction hallway or living room.
- **Loose Leash Street Walking:** Zero tension in leash. Immediate gentle directional turn upon any forward pull.

Homework: 15-min daily street walk | Goal: Calm loose leash + rapid down response

PHASE 2: BALL DRIVE, REWARD SWITCHING & RECALL

SESSION 5

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Ball Drive & Activity Switching Mechanics
Develop ball drive and teach the dog to switch between activities and rewards through clear, consistent practice.

- **Ball Drive Ignition:** Ball on string dragged erratically like moving prey to trigger enthusiasm and focus.
- **Drive Switching Loop:** During ball chase, use *"Yes," "Ya" or "Break"* to redirect dog back for a piece of kibble.
- **Bigger Reward Access:** Dog learns returning and taking kibble unlocks the bigger reward—the ball chase!

Homework: 3x 5-min switching sessions	Goal: Enthusiastic return to handler from ball

SESSION 6

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Progressive Distraction & Familiar Setting Exposure
Introduce manageable distractions, starting somewhere familiar (in front of the house) before busier locations.

- **Front-of-House Practice:** Step just outside the front door where environmental cues begin, maintaining handler focus.
- **Food Drop Control:** High-value food dropped at safe distance; redirect focus back to handler's lure.
- **Handler Mechanics Audit:** Assess both your handling footwork and your dog's current threshold capacity.

Homework: 10 front-of-house setups	Goal: Calm responsiveness outside front door

SESSION 7

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: The Magnet Recall (10m Long Line)
Building an enjoyable reflex where returning to the handler is consistently rewarded and never associated with punishment.

- **Restrained Recall:** Helper holds dog by chest; handler hypes up, sprints away & calls *COME!* Helper releases for sprint finish.
- **Jackpot Reinforcement:** Multiple high-value treats or an explosive game with the ball upon arrival.
- **Positive Association:** Never call the dog to end fun, bathe, or administer medication.

Homework: 5x long-line recalls daily	Goal: High-speed recall directly into front sit

SESSION 8

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Emergency Down During Exciting Activities
Practise the emergency down during higher-arousal games as the dog's understanding and reliability improve.

- **Arousal Down:** During a moving ball or toy game, give the emergency down cue. Reward instant collapse into posture.
- **Prey Call-Off:** Redirect dog off moving distractions using established markers (*Break / Ya / Yes*).
- **Jackpot Release:** After down is held calmly, release back to the moving ball as the ultimate reinforcer.

Homework: 2-3 emergency down drills	Goal: Reliable down response under excitement

PHASE 3: SOCIALISATION, CAFES & GRADUATION

SESSION 9: NEUTRAL SOCIALISATION & CAFE SETTLE

PRACTICE PERIOD: INDIVIDUAL PACE

Focus: Appropriate Socialisation & Emotional Neutrality
Socialisation means feeling comfortable and responding around people, dogs, sounds, and places—not greeting every dog.

- **Comfort Around Triggers:** Walking past other dogs and people at a distance where the dog can remain calm.
- **Cafe Settle:** Down-Stay under outdoor table at a dog-friendly cafe while pedestrians pass by. No greeting strangers.
- **Gradual Exposure:** If dog cannot yet walk calmly beside you, build skills at home and front of house first.

Homework: 2x 20-min outdoor cafe settles	Goal: Calm relaxation without fixation

SESSION 10: HARDWARE SHOP / PUBLIC FIELD TEST

CPT GRADUATION WALKTHROUGH

Focus: Real-World Public Environment Mastery
Progressing to a dog-friendly hardware shop (e.g. Bunnings) once handling skills and dog abilities are fully aligned.

- **Automatic Doors & Entry:** Smooth, confident entry on loose leash without pulling or hesitation.
- **Aisle Heeling:** Responsive loose-lead walking down aisles with handling skills guiding turns effortlessly.
- **Trolley Down-Stay:** Calm Down-Stay as flatbeds and shoppers pass by at a respectful distance.
- **CPT Graduation Sign-Off:** Official certification by Head Coach Sotir Kichukov.

Evaluation: 45-min walkthrough	Standard: 100% loose leash & calm partnership

HANDLER CODE OF CONDUCT (SOTIR'S GOLDEN RULES)

1. **Say It Once, Guide Smoothly:** Never repeat a verbal cue. If the dog is unsure, guide kinesthetically with your body and lure. Repeating words creates background noise.
2. **Assess Both Ends of the Leash:** If an exercise fails, assess both your handling timing and your dog's current capacity. Build foundations before stepping into busier spaces.
3. **Calm Handlers Create Calm Dogs:** Tension in your shoulders and hands travels directly down the leash. Breathe, stay relaxed, and enjoy working together.

OFFICIAL TRAINING LOG

Track individual practice sessions and note handler mechanics for Coach Sotir to review during progress audits.

SESSION	CORE MILESTONE	TARGET CRITERIA	HANDLER FIELD NOTES	DONE	SIGN
Session 1	Food Drive & Hand Magnet	Enthusiastic chasing & forward hand push		☐	
Session 2	Reward Focus & Drive Switch	Food focus (no eye contact requirement), BREAK marker		☐	
Session 3	S-Flow & 3 Positions	Smooth Sit/Down/Stand push-ups via lure		☐	
Session 4	Lure Fading & Emergency Down	Empty hand gesture + hallway emergency down		☐	
Session 5	Ball Drive & Reward Switch	Kibble redirect unlocks moving ball chase		☐	
Session 6	Distraction Proofing	Front-of-house calm responsiveness		☐	
Session 7	Magnet Long-Line Recall	Fast sprint return to handler with jackpot reward		☐	
Session 8	Emergency Down in Play	Reliable down response during higher arousal		☐	
Session 9	Neutrality & Cafe Settle	Calm settle around dogs/people without greeting		☐	
Session 10	Hardware Shop Walkthrough	Loose leash walking in dog-friendly retail space		☐	

CPT CANINE GRADUATION CERTIFICATION

Official authorization signed by Head Coach Sotir Kichukov upon Session 10 walkthrough.

Sotir Kichukov / Date